Finrep Server Fix Guide

Oct 26, 2026 · @Anuj

What's wrong

Login fails on the live site https://service.thefinrep.com because the server's Nginx is blocking every `/api` request. There is no bug in the code.

- Every API request gets the same reply: `503 {"status":503,"message":"Nginx update needed"}`.
- Nginx sends this message itself; requests never reach the Node backend. The backend's own headers are missing from the reply, and the message appears nowhere in the code.
- Nginx never shows a message like this on its own. Someone added a `return 503` rule to the server config on purpose. Nginx does not actually need an update.
- The project runs fine locally; it only needed `npm install`.

Item	Value
Live URL	https://service.thefinrep.com
Server IP	82.29.161.49 (Hostinger VPS, Ubuntu)
Web server	Nginx 1.24
Backend	Node.js, PM2 process `finrep`, port 4100
Frontend	`frontend/dist`, served by the backend
Database	MongoDB (`MONGO_URI` in `backend/.env`)

What to ask the client for

The first thing you need is a working SSH password. The password the client sent was rejected by the server (checked on 26 Oct 2026).

What to ask for	Why it's needed	Required?
New root password (reset from hPanel)	Log in to the server and fix Nginx	Yes

What to ask for	Why it's needed	Required?
Hostinger hPanel login	Password reset, browser terminal, server restart, backups	Yes (if no password)
Domain / DNS panel login	Point the domain at the server IP, SSL	Later
MongoDB login (likely Atlas)	Database errors like "IP not allowed", backups	Later
Latest code (GitHub/GitLab)	The live build differs from the build in the zip	Later

Message you can send the client:

> The SSH password isn't working; the server rejects it. Please go to Hostinger hPanel → VPS → Settings → Root password, set a new password and send it to me. Or share the hPanel login with me.

Also ask the client:

- Who added the "Nginx update needed" block, and why? It may have been a previous developer or agency. Confirm the client's permission before removing it.
- Should the current server be fixed, or should the app move to a new VPS? The Hostinger link the client sent is a cart link to buy a new VPS (KVM 2, 12 months), not a credential. A new server is not needed to get the site back up.

Terminal steps (from the start)

Run these steps in order once you have the new password. Check each step's output before moving on. Wherever `FILE` appears below, use the file name you find in Step 2.

Step 1: Connect to the server

Open PowerShell on Windows and run:

```
ssh root@82.29.161.49
```

- The first time it asks `yes/no`: type `yes`.
- At `password:`, enter the new password. Nothing shows while you type; that's normal. Right-click to paste.
- When you see `root@...:~#`, you're on the server.
- If the password is rejected, don't try more than twice, or your IP may get blocked.

Step 2: Find the blocking rule

```
grep -rn "Nginx update needed" /etc/nginx/
```

The output shows the file name and line number, e.g. `/etc/nginx/sites-enabled/finrep:15`.

Step 3: Take a backup

```
cp FILE /root/nginx-backup.conf
```

Step 4: View the file

```
cat FILE
```

Send this output to Claude. Every server's config is different, so confirm before editing.

Step 5: Edit the file

```
nano FILE
```

1. Use the arrow keys to go to the `return 503 ... Nginx update needed` line.
2. Press `Ctrl+K` to delete that line.
3. If that `location /` block has no `proxy_pass`, make it look like this:

```
location / {
    proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:4100;
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_set_header X-Real-IP $remote_addr;
    proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-For $proxy_add_x_forwarded_for;
    proxy_set_header X-Forwarded-Proto $scheme;
    client_max_body_size 20m;
}
```

4. Save: `Ctrl+O`, then Enter. Exit: `Ctrl+X`.

Step 6: Test and reload

```
nginx -t
```

Only if you see `syntax is ok` and `test is successful`, run:

```
systemctl reload nginx
```

Step 7: Check the backend (PM2)

```
pm2 list
```

If `finrep` shows `online`, go to Step 8. If it shows `stopped` / `errored` or isn't listed:

```
find / -name ecosystem.config.cjs -path "*backend*" 2>/dev/null
cd /path/to/backend
npm install --omit=dev
pm2 start ecosystem.config.cjs --env production
pm2 save
```

Replace `/path/to/backend` with the folder the first command prints.

Step 8: Test the site

```
curl http://127.0.0.1:4100/api/health
curl https://service.thefinrep.com/api/health
```

If both return `{"ok":true,...}`, the site is up. Open https://service.thefinrep.com in a browser and log in as super-admin. The login is in `backend/.env` under `SUPER_ADMIN_EMAIL` and `SUPER_ADMIN_PASSWORD`.

- [ ] Step 1: SSH login
- [ ] Steps 2–4: rule found, backup taken
- [ ] Steps 5–6: rule removed, Nginx reloaded
- [ ] Step 7: PM2 online
- [ ] Step 8: logged in on the site

If something goes wrong

If anything breaks, restore the backup first, then send the error output.

Problem	What to do
`Permission denied` (SSH)	Wrong password. Don't retry; ask the client to reset it from hPanel.
`Connection timed out` (SSH)	Server is down or port 22 is blocked. Check the VPS status in hPanel.

Problem	What to do
Error in `nginx -t`	Don't reload. Run `cp /root/nginx-backup.conf FILE` to restore the backup.
`502 Bad Gateway` on the site	Backend is down. Check `pm2 list` and `pm2 logs finrep --lines 50`.
`pm2: command not found`	Run `npm install -g pm2`, then repeat Step 7.
MongoDB error in PM2 logs	Check `MONGO_URI`, and allow server IP 82.29.161.49 in MongoDB Atlas.
Still shows "Nginx update needed"	Run the `grep` again; the rule may be in another file too. Then `systemctl reload nginx`.

To restore the backup:

```
cp /root/nginx-backup.conf FILE
nginx -t && systemctl reload nginx
```

After the fix

Once the site is up, secure server access with the client's permission so nobody can add the block again.

- [ ] Change the root password: `passwd`. Send the new password to the client securely; never paste it in chat.
- [ ] Review old SSH keys: `cat ~/.ssh/authorized_keys`. Remove any key you don't recognise, after checking with the client.
- [ ] Take a fresh backup: `cp FILE /root/nginx-working.conf`.
- [ ] `backend/.env` holds live payment and KYC keys. Don't share this file with anyone.

To run the project on your local machine, open two terminals:

```
cd backend
npm install
npm run dev
```

```
cd frontend
npm install
npm run dev
```

Then open http://127.0.0.1:5173. Note: `backend/.env` is set to production, so even local runs use the real database and real payment keys.